

Zachary Butler

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To the hiring manager:

I am writing to apply for the Digital Media Specialist position at the Health District of Northern Larimer County. I'm a video producer and digital storyteller with over ten years of experience creating content that helps people understand and relate to complex topics. That's the work I care about most, and it's what draws me to this role: using media to strengthen the connection between a community and the services that support it.

My background spans educational media, branded content, and digital strategy, and I believe that combination aligns well with what the Health District is looking for:

I know how to tell stories that make institutions feel human. At Cornell University's Center for Teaching Innovation, I produced documentary-style videos about teaching and learning that turned complex institutional topics into stories audiences actually wanted to watch—contributing to a 5x increase in the department's YouTube views and doubling its subscriber base. I also co-created [StoryLab](#), a digital storytelling program that helped instructors design assignments using video, audio, and multimedia—work grounded in the belief that storytelling is one of the most powerful tools we have for building understanding across differences.

I think strategically about how content lives across platforms. I've managed content workflows that span video, social media, web, and print, and I'm comfortable analyzing performance data to adjust what's working and rethink what isn't. At DEFY Media, I produced branded digital content for clients including Google, Sony, and Blizzard—learning to adapt tone, format, and distribution strategy to meet audiences where they are. That experience taught me to think about every piece of content not just as a standalone asset, but as part of a larger ecosystem.

I'm a hands-on producer who works well on small teams. At FBE (now React Media), I was one of three editors responsible for overnight production turnarounds for a subscriber base of over 30 million viewers—managing the full pipeline from edit through sound mix, color, and motion graphics. At Cornell, I worked on a small communications-adjacent team and collaborated regularly with program staff, designers, and subject matter experts across the organization. I'm used to wearing multiple hats and moving quickly without sacrificing quality.

I hold a master's degree in film and new media studies and recently moved to Laramie, Wyoming—just an hour from Fort Collins and willing to relocate if necessary. I'm excited about the opportunity to use my skills in service of community health. The Health District's commitment to showing up for people in meaningful, accessible ways is exactly the kind of mission I want my work to support. I would welcome the chance to discuss how my experience aligns with your team's needs.

View samples of my work at ctrlz.cc

Read more about Storylab at

<https://teaching.cornell.edu/learning-technologies/creative-technology-lab/storylab-digital-storytelling>

Sincerely,

Zach Butler